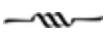
head in?' His intentions could have been above board but no one in the SIT approved of his leaking a crucial piece of evidence to the media while keeping the SIT in the dark.

Anirudhya felt he had got something that, in the cardinal language of journalism, was truly 'exclusive', something that would make his editors happy. He finished writing his interview of the person who was considered the forensic czar of India and sent it to his editors.



Bobb's printer churned out the final copy of Shekhar Gupta's story, part of which read:

> The short, stout, dark and bespectacled, woman, somewhere in her mid-30s, would have mingled indistinguishably in any Tamil election crowd but for one incongruity: she wore a salwar-kameez. But so many Tamil women have discarded the sari for the more practical northern dress, particularly in Madras. So, a mere 50 km away, the police were not about to get unduly perturbed by the sight of a nondescript woman just because she was clad in salwar-kameez. Twelve hours later, with no more than two dismembered legs, a severed head, bits of a denim-and-velcro belt, fragments of a detonating switch and battery as clues, some of the country's top investigators, forensic scientists and explosives experts from the NSG were struggling to piece together the rest of the jigsaw, the key to which lay in the identity of the dead assassin.[3]

Shekhar, with inputs from the Madras bureau and Anirudhya in Delhi, went on to write that Rajiv's personal security officer, ACP Pradip Dutta, had recently told him that he was aware of Rajiv's careless attitude towards security restrictions while mingling with the crowd at public meetings. But the ACP had assured him that if anything were to happen to Rajiv, it would be over his own dead body. Ironically, that's exactly what happened. ACP